

Research Article Review

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ELDT 5100: Technology Integration in Education

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School districts have been investing a significant amount of money in technology; however, overall student outcomes have remained stable instead of increasing as intended. The objective of Edelberg's (2020) research study was to investigate how K-12 public school district superintendents perceive their own roles and responsibilities as instructional technology leaders. Edelberg adapted a 20-year-old survey from Brush and Bannon to evaluate how superintendents rate the importance of technology implementation in their districts. The results showed that superintendents highly valued making plans and setting goals, but placed a significantly lower value on leaders holding credentials in instructional technology. Additionally, superintendents who self-reported low personal technology skills rated a leader's formal educational background as more important, while the superintendents who self-reported being "tech-savvy" placed a much lower emphasis on leaders needing specialized technology degrees or credentials. Overall, the study concluded that district leaders prioritize the logistical implementation of technology rather than the pedagogical strategies needed to improve classroom instruction.

An internal threat to validity that the study presents is that all the surveys were completed via self-reports from the superintendents. Because of this, social desirability may have played a part in how superintendents responded, causing them to make themselves look better and rendering the results less honest or true. A present threat to content validity is how well this study effectively assesses what it intended to assess. The adapted 20-year-old survey, while used to see how results compared to the original use, may not be completely applicable to today. Technology usage in schools has vastly changed, so the survey may not have fully encapsulated what technology integration requires today. Furthermore, a major limitation this study has is that it only used demographics for district enrollment size and the superintendents' personal knowledge levels and did not compare socioeconomic statuses. Technology availability and integration can

vary greatly depending on the socioeconomic status of the area, meaning these results may not be generalizable to all school types.

This article aligns with the ISTE Educational Leadership Visionary Planner standard, as the study pertains to how technology implementation is planned and continuously evaluated. Edelberg showed that superintendents agree that creating a technology plan and establishing district goals are important (3.2.b). However, the superintendents fell short on evaluating the plan's progress as technology was implemented (3.2.c). Additionally, superintendents did not ensure that teachers had the proper competency to execute the technology implementation, showing a lack of effective continuous communication with stakeholders (3.2.d).

References

- Edelberg, T. (2020). Emphasizing technology over instruction: Adapting a 20-year-old survey to examine the climate of K–12 instructional technology leadership in public school districts. *Journal of School Leadership*, 30(3), 257–274.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/1052684619884783>